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ENGROSSED HOUSE  
BILL NO. 3980

and  
Gollihare of the Senate

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

This act shall be known and may be cited as the "Rural District Attorney Loan Repayment Assistance Program".

As used in the Rural District Attorney Loan Repayment Program:

1        1. "Eligible employee" means a person who is employed full-time  
2 as an assistant district attorney in the State of Oklahoma and who  
3 has incurred a debt pursuant to the obligations under a qualified  
4 education loan;

5        2. "Qualified education loan" means a debt owed by the eligible  
6 employee to any private or public entity for which repayment is  
7 legally required over a period greater than one (1) year, the  
8 proceeds of which were used to pay tuition, fees, or other education  
9 expenses, including books and materials, to an institution of higher  
10 learning, including any private college or university, for  
11 coursework leading to an undergraduate or graduate degree; and

12        3. "Required payback period" means two thousand (2,000) hours  
13 of full-time employment as an assistant district attorney in a  
14 designated high-need jurisdiction for each Five Thousand Dollars  
15 (\$5,000.00) of qualified education loan expenses paid pursuant to  
16 this act.

17        SECTION 3.        NEW LAW        A new section of law to be codified  
18 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 215.42c of Title 19, unless  
19 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

20        A. The District Attorneys Council, subject to available  
21 funding, may make direct payments not to exceed Five Thousand  
22 Dollars (\$5,000.00) in any twelve-month period, on behalf of an  
23 eligible employee to any private or public entity for which a  
24 qualified education loan expense is owed by the eligible employee.

1 B. With regards to payments made under this section, the  
2 District Attorneys Council shall not make cumulative payments on  
3 behalf of any single eligible employee that total an amount greater  
4 than Fifty Thousand Dollars (\$50,000.00).

5 C. The provisions of this section shall only be applicable to  
6 qualified education loan obligations incurred prior to employment as  
7 an assistant district attorney or qualified education loan  
8 obligations associated with education directly related to employment  
9 incurred during such employment.

10 D. Payments made pursuant to this section shall be made  
11 directly to the loan service provider or lending institution.

12 SECTION 4. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified  
13 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 215.42d of Title 19, unless  
14 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

15 A. If an eligible employee on whose behalf payment has been  
16 made pursuant to this act terminates services in a designated high-  
17 need jurisdiction prior to the expiration of the required payback  
18 period, the employee shall be required to reimburse the payor entity  
19 for the amount of the qualified education loan expense paid.

20 B. If the employee performs less than the number of hours of  
21 service required for the full amount of the expenses paid,  
22 reimbursement shall be made on a pro rata basis, based upon the  
23 actual number of hours of service performed.

1       SECTION 5.       NEW LAW       A new section of law to be codified  
2 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 215.42e of Title 19, unless  
3 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

4       A.   Eligibility for participation in the Rural District Attorney  
5 Loan Repayment Assistance Program shall be determined by a selection  
6 committee composed of representatives of the district attorneys, in  
7 coordination with the District Attorneys Council.

8       B.   The committee shall designate high-need jurisdictions based  
9 on factors including, but not limited to:

- 10       1.   Population size;
- 11       2.   Remoteness or rural characteristic of the district;
- 12       3.   Length of vacancies or turnover rate;
- 13       4.   Distance to institutions of higher education; and
- 14       5.   Other workforce requirement and retention considerations.

15       C.   Eligible employees shall submit documentation of qualified  
16 education loan obligations and payments schedules annually, in a  
17 manner prescribed by the committee.

18       SECTION 6.       NEW LAW       A new section of law to be codified  
19 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 215.42f of Title 19, unless  
20 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

21       Nothing in this act shall be construed to create a vested right  
22 to loan assistance payments.   Loan assistance payments are subject  
23 to availability of funds and continued eligibility as determined by  
24 the administering committee.

SECTION 7. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 215.42g of Title 19, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

There is hereby created in the State Treasury a revolving fund for the District Attorneys Council to be designated the "Rural District Attorney Loan Repayment Assistance Program Revolving Fund". The fund shall be a continuing fund, not subject to fiscal year limitations, and shall consist of all monies directed for deposit to the fund by law. All monies accruing to the credit of said fund are hereby appropriated and may be budgeted and expended by the District Attorneys Council for the purpose of direct payments for qualified education loan payments on behalf of eligible employees. Expenditures from said fund shall be made upon warrants issued by the State Treasurer against claims filed as prescribed by law with the Director of the Office of Management and Enterprise Services for approval and payment.

SECTION 8. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON JUDICIARY  
April 7, 2026 - DO PASS